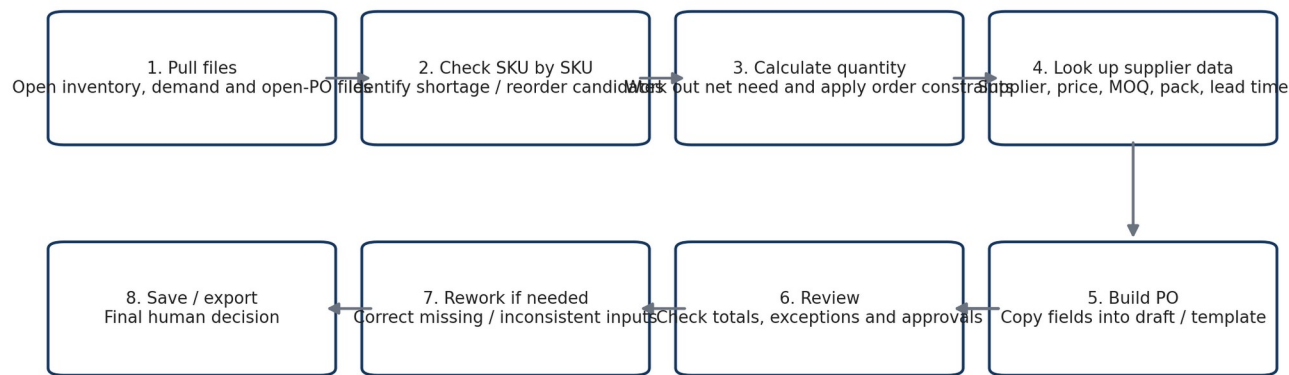


Current Process and Baseline Study

Current-state workflow and manual benchmark

Purpose. Document how a buyer prepares a purchase order today and establish a baseline that can be compared fairly with the agent-assisted workflow.

Current manual workflow - analyst baseline



Main issue: the buyer carries the logic in their head while switching between data, rules and a PO template.

1. Detailed manual workflow

Step	Buyer activity	Where friction enters	Observation
1	Open the latest inventory, demand and open-PO data	File switching; version risk	Start time, files opened
2	Scan each SKU and decide whether it needs replenishment	Repeated judgement	SKU checks, skipped SKUs
3	Calculate net requirement / proposed quantity	Manual calculation	Calculations, corrections
4	Look up supplier and commercial fields	Search / lookup effort	Lookups, missing fields
5	Check order modifiers and rules	Cognitive load	Rule checks, rule misses
6	Copy valid lines into PO draft	Re-keying	Fields typed / pasted

Step	Buyer activity	Where friction enters	Observation
7	Recalculate line amounts and total	Duplicate work	Manual calculations
8	Review draft and exceptions	Late error discovery	Review time, rework
9	Correct data or quantity and repeat checks	Loop / rework	Rework cycles
10	Approve, save or hold	Human judgement	Final outcome

2. Baseline study protocol

1. Choose a fixed set of scenarios that will later be repeated with the agent. Do not give the manual participant easier data.
2. Provide only the files and rules a buyer would reasonably have in the current process.
3. Start the timer when the participant opens the task pack; stop when the draft is ready for review or the participant declares the case blocked.
4. Record every file switch, spreadsheet lookup, manual calculation, copy/paste, field edit, exception lookup and rework cycle.
5. After the run, compare the final output with the agreed expected answer. Separate quantity errors, commercial-rule errors, missing exceptions and PO-field errors.
6. Ask the participant which step required the most attention and which error they were most worried about making.

3. Manual action taxonomy

Action type	Counting rule
File switch	Open / switch between inventory, demand, open PO, supplier data or PO template.
Lookup	Search for SKU, supplier, price, MOQ, pack or another field.
Calculation	Any arithmetic done manually or in a temporary spreadsheet cell.
Transfer	Copy, paste or re-key a value into the PO draft.
Rule check	Explicitly compare a proposed line against a requirement.
Correction	Edit a previously entered value because of an error or new discovery.
Decision	Buyer judgement: proceed, hold, request data, approve.

4. Baseline data sheet

Field	Recorded value
Scenario ID	

Field	Recorded value
Participant	
Start time	
End time	
Total seconds	
File switches	
Lookups	
Calculations	
Transfers / edits	
Rule checks	
Rework cycles	
Final correctness	
Notes	

Why this matters Without a manual baseline, the team can only say the agent “feels faster.” A measured baseline lets the final demo show a before/after comparison using the same work unit.